Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report

Ty Canol

Neath

01792326826

The inspection visit took place on 03/07/2026

Service Information:

Operated by:	National Autistic Society
Care Type:	Care Home Service Adults Without Nursing
Provision for:	Care home for adults - with personal care, Provision for learning disability
Registered places:	3
Main language(s):	English
Promotion of Welsh language and culture:	The provider makes an effort to promote the use of the Welsh language and culture or is working towards a bilingual service.

Ratings:

Well-being	Good
Care & Support	Good
Environment	Good
Leadership & Management	Good

Summary:

Ty Canol is located in Neath and provides personal care and support to people. It is close to a number of community facilities which can be easily accessed from the service. During this inspection, we found significant improvements have been made since the previous inspection in March 2026. Earlier concerns relating to care planning, leadership, care staff support, training compliance, and governance have largely been addressed. The service has been rated good in all four themes.

We saw people's independence consistently promoted and people benefit from person-centred care which enables them to make meaningful choices and achieve personal goals.
Personal plans have improved considerably and are now detailed, regularly reviewed and supported by appropriate risk assessments. Daily records are detailed and informative.

The environment is well-maintained and we saw improvements are planned to further enhance the environment for people. Leadership and management have strengthened since the last inspection. Supervisions, team meetings and training compliance have improved, and care staff report higher morale, better teamwork and increased management support. Quality assurance processes are

focused on wellbeing and service development.

Findings:

Well-being — Good

People live healthily and safely with control over their lives. People experience positive well-being outcomes because they are supported by staff who know them well. People are actively involved in making choices about how they spend their time and are supported to maintain meaningful hobbies and interests that matter to them. There has been significant progress achieved since the previous inspection and the service has demonstrated a strong commitment to continuous improvement, with enhanced care planning and more detailed outcome-focused records. These improvements have improved people's well-being outcomes, and provide consistent, person-centred support. During the inspection, people were observed preparing to participate in activities they enjoy such as playing golf and accessing local community facilities. Care documentation clearly outlined individual communication methods, health needs and personal outcomes, enabling staff to provide person-centred support that promotes independence while managing risks safely.

People are safe and protected from abuse and neglect. Staff demonstrate a clear understanding of their safeguarding responsibilities and are confident in recognising, reporting and responding to concerns. Detailed and personalised risk assessments enable people to take positive risks whilst maintaining their safety, rights and independence. There are robust security arrangements in place, including visitor monitoring procedures. We saw staff have a good understanding of individual support needs and interactions between staff and people were warm and respectful.

People are supported to cultivate safe and healthy relationships. People maintain meaningful connections with those important to them and are encouraged to access their local community facilities. We saw people have regular contact with family and other people important to them. Relatives play an active role in people's lives and decision-making and told us they are happy with the care their relative receives. One relative told us their loved one *"is happy and content whenever I see them".*

People live in accommodation that supports their well-being outcomes. People live in a well-maintained, comfortable and personalised home that promotes dignity and independence. The environment is clean and welcoming with effective infection prevention and control measures in place throughout the service. Bedrooms reflect people's individual interests and preferences. Communal areas are spacious, homely and suitable for both relaxation and social engagement. Effective maintenance, health and safety systems and secure outdoor spaces further supported positive outcomes.

Care & Support — Good

People receive good quality care and support that helps them achieve their personal outcomes. People benefit from personalised care and support that is planned, reviewed and delivered in a way that reflects their individual needs, preferences, strengths and aspirations. Since the previous inspection, there has been a notable improvement in the quality of personal planning, with care records providing clear guidance for staff on how to support people to achieve the outcomes that matter to them. Care plans are detailed, regularly reviewed and informed by input from relatives, advocates and professionals, ensuring people experience continuity and consistency of care. Daily records are completed thoroughly and show the support received by people and the progress made towards personal goals. Relatives remain actively involved in care and decision-making, and healthcare professionals' guidance is reflected within support plans.

People are protected from harm and abuse. People are supported by staff who have a good understanding of safeguarding responsibilities and who place people's safety, rights and dignity at the heart of their care. Staff demonstrated a good understanding of individual needs and are committed to providing person centred care. Staff spoken with are confident in reporting concerns and described a culture that promotes openness and professional accountability. One staff member told us, *"I feel more comfortable raising ideas and feel they will be taken on board,"* whilst another stated, *"Things have gotten a lot better in a short amount of time."*

Medication is safely managed and stored securely. Temperature monitoring is completed consistently, and medication administration records are accurately maintained with no gaps in recording. Competency assessments and monitoring arrangements are in place to ensure staff were suitably skilled to manage medicines safely. Support needs regarding medication are clearly detailed in people’s personal plans.

The risk of infection is minimised within the service, and people live in an environment where infection prevention and control practices are embedded into daily routines and promoted by care staff. We saw the home is clean and hygienic with appropriate supplies of personal protective equipment readily available and accessible. Staff demonstrate a good understanding of infection prevention measures and receive training in this area. Monitoring systems, audits and routine checks provide effective oversight of infection control arrangements and support continuous improvement.

Environment

Good

People live in an environment with appropriate and well-maintained facilities and equipment to help them achieve their well-being outcomes while identifying, mitigating and reducing health and safety risks. The environment is comfortable, homely and spacious whilst promoting people's independence, dignity and overall well-being. During the inspection, we saw the home is clean, clutter free and welcoming. People's bedrooms are highly personalised with photographs of family and friends, items reflecting their interests, hobbies and personal achievements, helping to create a strong sense of belonging and ownership. The home offers communal and private spaces, including a large lounge, spacious kitchen, en-suite bedrooms and well-maintained outdoor areas, allowing people to choose how and where they spend their time. We also saw people actively involved in decisions about their environment, including discussions regarding planned kitchen redecoration, demonstrating that their views are valued and influence the ongoing development of the service.

The environment has been thoughtfully adapted to meet people's sensory and cognitive needs, with uncluttered spaces and a calm atmosphere that supports positive daily experiences. Outdoor and external areas provide safe, accessible and peaceful areas people can enjoy whenever they wish. Effective arrangements are in place to ensure the environment remains safe and well maintained. Regular testing and servicing of fire safety systems, emergency lighting, electrical installations, water temperatures, gas appliances and portable electrical equipment were completed. Weekly maintenance and environmental checks further support the early identification of repairs and maintenance requirements.

Effective security arrangements are in place to protect people while safeguarding their rights, privacy and dignity. There is secure entry to the service and a visitor's book is maintained to ensure a log of people accessing the building is maintained along with complying with fire regulations. Outdoor spaces are secure, accessible and well maintained, providing additional opportunities for recreation and relaxation. Minor issues were identified during the inspection to which managers responded promptly reflecting a proactive approach to health and safety management and a commitment to continuous improvement.

Leadership & Management — Good

The service provider has effective organisational arrangements, governance and oversight to ensure smooth operations and high-quality care. There have been significant and sustained improvements in relation to leadership and management of the service since the previous inspection. The provider demonstrates a clear commitment to improving outcomes for people through enhanced oversight, improved quality assurance systems and a greater focus on person-centred practice. The service's ability to implement significant improvements within a relatively short period demonstrates strong organisational capacity and a clear commitment to delivering good-quality care. The Responsible Individual visits the service frequently and speaks to people, staff and family members to gather feedback about the service. They use this information to complete regulatory reports which are focused on evaluating people's experiences and identifying opportunities for further improvements where necessary.

People are supported by a staff team with the necessary expertise, skills, and qualifications to meet people's care and support needs. Care staff are provided with the support, guidance and development opportunities necessary to perform their roles effectively and deliver person-centred care. Training compliance has improved significantly since the previous inspection, and staff are able to describe how training supported them to deliver high-quality care. One member of staff told us, *"The training is very good here, it has prepared me a lot."* Care staff spoken to are engaged and committed to delivering person-centred support.

The culture within the service is positive, open and focused on continuous improvement. Feedback from staff demonstrates confidence in the current management arrangements and highlights the positive impact stable leadership has had on the service. One care staff member told us, *"I feel very supported now,"* whilst another commented, *"Things are a lot better now, it feels more like a team."* We saw care staff are supported through regular supervision, ongoing guidance and accessible management support, creating a learning culture where reflective practice and professional development are actively encouraged. Regular team meetings are held within the service and minutes of these meetings show these are two-way discussions and staff are encouraged to contribute. Care staff told us they felt valued, listened to and confident raising ideas or concerns.

Areas identified for improvement

Where we identify **Areas for Improvement** but we have not found outcomes for people to be at immediate or significant risk, we discuss these with the provider. We expect the provider to take action and we will follow this up at the next inspection.

Where we find outcomes for people **require significant improvement** and/or there is risk to people's well-being we identify areas for **Priority Action**. In these circumstances we issue a Priority Action Notice(s) to the Provider, and they must take immediate steps to make improvements. We will inspect again within six months to check improvements have been made and outcomes for people have improved.

CIW has no areas for improvement identified following this inspection.

CIW has not issued any Priority action notices following this inspection.

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